Finly

Checklist For Choosing The Right Expense Management Software For Your Business



Introduction

There's a lot to consider when choosing an expense management software solution. It's important to match your own needs to the functionality offered, and then deciding on selecting the most cost efficient, easy to adopt system.

We have put together a checklist that will help guide you to decide which expense management software solution is right for your business.

1. Defining the problems and what is to be achieved

The first step in choosing an expense management software solution is to ask yourself what challenge you are trying to solve. Perhaps your business is continuously experiencing:

1. Time-consuming processes for employees, approver and accountant
2. Incorrect employee expense reports
3. Expense fraud
4. Difficulties in processing expenses in accounting software

It's probably good if you could down run through the checklist shown below and identify the answers to these questions.

Questions	Answer
How do employees submit expenses at the moment?	e.g. Excel, paper based expense reporting or maintaining ledger books
Do you have control before spend occurs?	
Do you have complete visibility over who is spending, how much and where within the organisation?	
How and where are receipts being stored?	
Do you keep digital copies of the receipts?	

How fast do the Employees get reimbursed?	
Do your employees incur out of pocket expenses?	
How many errors are being made at the moment?	
Is there a need for approval of expenses before reimbursement? How is this done at the moment?	

2. Framing Your Requirements

Your requirements can be framed by answering each of the questions below. This could help you have a better discussion with an Expense Management vendor:

Question	Answer
How are money advances given to employees?	E.g. We hand them over with cash or we provide them with Credit Cards etc.
Is there a way the system can be used without any reporting effort from the Employees side?	
How sophisticated is your team in learning new technology?	
Who is going to use the solution? Is it just a couple of employees; a certain department or will it be used by the entire business?	
Do you need support and training for you and your team to get started?	
How much mobility do you want? Do you need the software to be accessible on mobile phones and tablets?	
What other business applications do you have that you want to integrate with the expense management system (like accounting or ERP)?	

3. Pricing

Budgetary concerns play a role in which travel and expense management solution you choose. Some businesses are being constrained by current business conditions. Other businesses are able to take a longer-term view of their Expense Management Software investment.

When looking for the right tool, you must be aware that other vendors may include indirect fees such as upgrade fee, customer support fee, software license renewal fee and more. It would be best to look for software that is free from hidden charges and sets a straightforward pricing.

Questions	Answers
What is the cost structure?	E.g. Pay as you go – per user – per month. You're not bound to the vendor and can leave whenever you want.
What is the setup Cost & Process?	
How customizable is the system to fit your Company needs?	

4. Involve the stakeholders in the Organisation

There are a lot of people in your company that are involved when it comes to expense management. It starts with the employee who has to report his expenses, an approver who has to go through all those receipts and reports.

User	Questions	Answer
Employee	How do you currently capture and report your expenses?	
	How often do you incur out of pocket expenses?	

	How much time do you spend in recording nd reporting expenses?	
	How much time does it take for you to get reimbursed?	
	How do you manage your receipts until you submit them?	
Approver	How do you approve expenses filed by employees at the moment?	
	How much time do you spend in the process of reviewing expenses?	
	Do you keep track of Company Policies while reviewing expenses?	
CFO	How do you gain intelligence out of the expense reports at the moment?	
	Do you have real time visibility of Company Expenses?	
	How do you disburse Cash to Employees?	
	How updated is accounting system?	
	What can be improved?	

5. Check if your vendor supports you with the features you need

We divided this checklist into 4 parts, each part is essential in expense reporting. First of all we start with the expense policy to make sure the application meets the needs of your expense policy. Then we will look at expense submission, expense management and last but not least exporting tools and integrations.
Expense policy features

Feature	What	Answer
Multi User	Is the solution for single users only or can more users be added under the same account?	
Group- role and branch management	Can you assign users a specific role and/or assign them to a group?	
Categories	Are you able to add your own categories and assign them to expenses?	
Custom Fields	Can you create custom felds (and make them mandatory?)	
Projects	Can you add projects and assign them to the expenses?	

Approval	Is it possible to use an approval ow?	
Mileage, Time-tracking & Advances	Does the application supports the submission of mileage – time tracking and advances?	
Prepaid Card	Is it possible to add prepaid cards and select them as payment method?	

Submitting expenses

Feature	What	Answer
Expense Submission	How can expenses be submitted to the application?	
Integrations	Are there integrations available to submit expenses (e.g. Dropbox or Evernote?)	
Mobile Apps	Are there mobile apps available to submit expenses and on what devices do they run?	
Receipt Scanning	Does the app reads out all data of the receipts submitted?	
Receipt Storage	How long are the digitized receipts stored?	
Supports additional Data	Is it possible to add extra information to an expense such as category or project?	
Supports Multiple Currency	Is it possible to use different currencies for separate users?	

Exporting and reporting tools

Feature	What	Answer
Filtering tools	Does the app has filtering tools and are they easy to work with?	
Exporting tools	Does the app has exporting tools? How do they work and which export formats (pdf – csv – excel)?	
Approval Flow	Does the approval ow blocks unapproved expenses on reports?	
Accounting integrations	Which accounting software does the app integrate with?	
Open API	Does the app has an API to connect with?	

Support Availability

Feature	What	Answer
Phone Support	Speak to someone if you have an issue?	
Email Support	Support for less urgent issues or questions?	
Live Chat	Is live chat available online?	
User Guides	Does the software come with helpful guides?	

Conclusion

So there you have it – those are the benchmarks of choosing the right expense management platform to use to fuel up expense management in your business. Always remember that accuracy in expense reports is essential to your business' welfare; it results to better ROI (return on investment), higher corporate policy compliance, better utilization of company resources and overall operational boost.

Expense Management Software is the key to control and manage your day to day business expenses. Having an expense management solution that is easy to use for employees, accountant, CFO and manager is essential to organize this critical business information and to improve the bottom line.

Whether you're a small, medium or large-sized company, Expense Management Software is the one application which is crucial to your company's success.

Finly is a secure and highly flexible expense management product for businesses to effectively streamline expenses, automates reporting and approvals, instantly processes cash advance requests & reimbursements.

Schedule a demo with us and we will be in touch with you shortly!

Schedule a Demo

Follow us on

Check us out at www.finly.io
Email us at contact@finly.io